

If the three hypothetical Data Records shown above were the complete NIPS file, then that NIPS file would contain eight records. The first Data Record (A) would have two records, the second Data Record (B) would have four records, and the third Data Record (C) would have two records.

For the translated files, each record has a fixed length of 247 record positions. Each record includes the record positions for the fixed set and for the periodic set. The data for the fixed set is always present within each translated record and specific fields within the fixed set, known as the control set, serve as the unique identifier for each record. The first instances of the periodic set are found in the translated record. Additional instances of the periodic set data are written to additional records but with the same fixed set data as the first instance. Using the hypothetical NIPS file shown above, the eight NIPS records would become five translated records. The new arrangement would be:

Translated Record 1 = Fixed Set A + Periodic Set #1 A1
Translated Record 2 = Fixed Set B + Periodic Set #1 B1
Translated Record 3 = Fixed Set B + Periodic Set #1 B2
Translated Record 4 = Fixed Set B + Periodic Set #1 B3
Translated Record 5 = Fixed Set C + Periodic Set #1 C1

Record Layout.

NWME created a record layout for the AWADS translation data file using the element format (field definitions / File Format Table) in the AWADS NIPS file and the agency documentation. The record layout (Folder 4, Translation File Record Layout) contains the Column Name, Title / Description, Data Type, Start Position, End Position, and Column Width. The last column in the record layout text file named "LINE-END" was not derived from the NIPS file or agency documentation and was added during the translation process. The "LINE-END" column accounts for two characters that were inserted at the end of each record (Record Positions 248 – 249) in the translation data file when it was originally copied to CDR before preservation copying. The two characters, indicating the end of a record, were not transferred to the preservation copy of the translation data file. The record length of the translation data file is a total of 247 record positions as indicated in the element format (field definitions / File Format Table) of the NIPS file and the agency documentation. The table below depicts the record layout of the AWADS translation data file. The location of the columns in the control set, fixed set, and periodic set are indicated on the left.

Set	Column Name	Title	Data Type	Start Position	End Position	Width
Control	SERPX	SERVICE NUMBER PREFIX	VARCHAR2	1	2	2
Control	SERNO	SERVICE NUMBER	VARCHAR2	3	10	10
Fixed	SEQNO	SEQUENCE NUMBER	NUMBER	11	13	3
Fixed	NAME	NAME OF INDIVIDUAL	VARCHAR2	14	31	18
Fixed	GRDCD	GRADE CODE	VARCHAR2	32	33	2
Fixed	CMD	COMMAND / STAFF CODE	VARCHAR2	34	35	2

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Set	Column Name	Title	Data Type	Start Position	End Position	Width
Fixed	CMDNM	COMMAND / STAFF NAME	VARCHAR2	36	72	37
Fixed	SVC	SERVICE / COUNTRY CODE	VARCHAR2	73	73	1
Fixed	SVCNM	SERVICE / COUNTRY NAME	VARCHAR2	74	103	30
Fixed	DEROS	DATE ELIGIBLE TO RETURN FROM OVERSEAS	DATE	104	108	5
Periodic	AWDRC	RECOMMENDED AWARD CODE	VARCHAR2	109	112	4
Periodic	DTDRC	DATE RECOMMENDED AWARD RECEIVED	DATE	113	117	5
Periodic	DTDAC	DATE OF ACTION	VARCHAR2	118	123	6
Periodic	AWDPV	APPROVED AWARD CODE	VARCHAR2	124	127	4
Periodic	CLUS	CLUSTER CODE	VARCHAR2	128	128	1
Periodic	BRDNO	BOARD NUMBER	VARCHAR2	129	131	3
Periodic	MACRC	MACV RECOMMENDED AWARD CODE	VARCHAR2	132	135	4
Periodic	LEASS	LEVEL OF ASSIGNMENT	VARCHAR2	136	139	4
Periodic	GONO	GENERAL ORDER NUMBER	VARCHAR2	140	143	4
Periodic	DTDFW	DATE AWARD FORWARDED	DATE	144	148	5
Periodic	PVN	AWARD PRESENTED IN RVN	VARCHAR2	149	149	1
Periodic	POSTHU	POSTHUMOUS	VARCHAR2	150	150	1
Fixed	SPAR1	SPARE FIELD	VARCHAR2	151	152	2
Fixed	SPAR2	SPARE FIELD	NUMBER	153	156	4
Fixed	SPAR3	SPARE FIELD	NUMBER	157	161	5
Fixed	SPAR4	SPARE FIELD	VARCHAR2	162	176	15
Fixed	SPAR5	SPARE FIELD	VARCHAR2	177	216	40
Periodic	SPAR6	SPARE FIELD	VARCHAR2	217	218	2
Periodic	SPAR7	SPARE FIELD	NUMBER	219	222	4
Periodic	SPAR8	SPARE FIELD	NUMBER	223	227	5
Periodic	SPAR9	SPARE FIELD	VARCHAR2	228	247	20
	LINE-END	Line-End		248	249	2

Original Data Editing and Verification.

During the Vietnam conflict subject matter specialists transcribed the AWADS data onto keypunch coding sheets. Then keypunch operators used these coding sheets to produce the AWADS punch cards. The computer used the punch cards, together with the FFS programs, to create the AWADS file for NIPS.

In examining the information currently on the AWADS file, it appears that editing and verification of the AWADS data was somewhat lax when this file was originally created. These types of errors created in the original records have been maintained in the translated file.

ASCII Conversion. Some changes were made to the translated files. The original AWADS NIPS file was coded in the 8-bit Extended Binary Coded Decimal Interchange Code (EBCDIC) and the translated file is coded in the 8-bit American National Standard Code for

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Short Name	Long Name	Alpha Numeric	Length	Start Column	End Column
servc	Service Number	A	10	1	10 *
serpx	Service Number Prefix	A	2	1	2
serno	Service Number	A	8	3	10 *
seqno	Sequence Number	N	3	11	13
name	Name of Individual	A	18	14	31
grdcd	Grade Code	A	2	32	33
cmd	Command/Staff Code	A	2	34	35
cmdnm	Command/Staff Name	A	37	36	72
svc	Service/Country Code	A	1	73	73
svcnm	Service/Country Name	A	30	74	103
deros	Date Eligible to Return from Overseas	A	5	104	108
awdrc	Recommended Award Code	A	4	109	112
dtddrc	Date Recommended Award Received	A	5	113	117
dtddac	Date of Action	A	6	118	123
awdpv	Approved Award Code	A	4	124	127
clus	Cluster Code	A	1	128	128
brdno	Board Number	A	3	129	131
macrc	MACV Recommended Award Code	A	4	132	135
leass	Level of Assignment	A	4	136	139
gono	General Order Number	A	4	140	143
dtddfw	Date Award Forwarded	A	5	144	148
pvn	Award Presented in RVN?	A	1	149	149
poshu	Posthumous	A	1	150	150
spar1	Spare Field	A	2	151	152
spar2	Spare Field	N	4	153	156
spar3	Spare Field	N	5	157	161
spar4	Spare Field	A	15	162	176
spar5	Spare Field	A	40	177	216
spar6	Spare Field	A	2	217	218
spar7	Spare Field	N	4	219	222
spar8	Spare Field	N	5	223	227
spar9	Spare Field	A	20	228	247
	LINE-END		2	248	249

* According to the documentation there are two fields with the same name.